YIFEI SUN

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Coinbase Hiring Team
Senior Staff Software Engineer, Backend — Platform (Core Automation)

Dear Coinbase Hiring Team,

I'm writing to express my interest in the Senior Staff Software Engineer, Core Automation role. The vision of building an AI automation platform from day 1 — starting with customer support and compliance, extracting reusable primitives, then scaling across every domain — is exactly the kind of high-impact, greenfield platform work I've built my career around.

I bring direct experience shipping agentic AI systems to production. I recently designed and implemented an MCP server on the OpenAI Apps SDK as the sole backend engineer, enabling ChatGPT agents to invoke our platform's capabilities via structured tool calls — defining tool schemas, orchestration logic, and production rollout strategy under high ambiguity. Separately, I built a GenAI automation platform with multi-provider LLM orchestration, an evaluation harness with hallucination detection and backtesting, and a configurable policy framework for safe, iterative automation improvement.

Beyond AI, I have 13 years of distributed backend experience at the Senior Staff/Principal level. At CarGurus, I led a cross-org platform modernization spanning 10+ teams across 3 departments, reducing p99 latency 5× and achieving 99.9% availability. I defined the platform primitives — orchestration layer, API standards, and architectural patterns — that became the foundation other teams built on. This pattern of building reusable primitives from domain-specific work mirrors exactly what Core Automation's Phase 2 envisions.

I'm drawn to Coinbase's conviction that AI will fundamentally change how companies operate. Building AI automation in a financial context — where correctness and grounding are non-negotiable — is a genuinely hard and important problem. I'd welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience building agentic AI systems and extractable platform primitives can help Core Automation move from day 1 to scale.

Sincerely,

Yifei Sun